

```
<svg
xmlns="http://www.w3.org/2000/svg"
viewBox="0 0 180 180" fill="none"
role="img" aria-label="beginner seed
mark"><rect width="180" height="180"
rx="40" fill="#2d5a3d"/><path d="M68
38 L68 138" stroke="#f5f3ef" stroke-
width="10.5" stroke-linecap="round"/>
<path d="M68 82 C68 68, 82 58, 100 58
C122 58, 132 72, 132 90 C132 108, 122
122, 100 122 C82 122, 68 112, 68 98Z"
stroke="#f5f3ef" stroke-width="10.5"
fill="none" stroke-linejoin="round"/>
<path d="M68 56 C66 44, 78 34, 92 38
C88 44, 74 50, 68 56Z" fill="#7bc47a"/>
<path d="M68 48 C67 42, 60 38, 54 40
C56 44, 64 47, 68 48Z" fill="#5aad58"
opacity="0.7"/></svg>
```

beginner

Everyone is a founder.



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C68 68, 82 58, 100 58 C122 58, 132

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C66 44, 78 34, 92 38 C88 44, 74 50,

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d="M68 48 C67 42, 60 38, 54 40 C36

44, 64 47, 68 48Z" fill="#5aad58"

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beginne

Tyler Lindow

10 years elevating engineers: From
science museums to IPOs.

What have I learned?

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C68 68, 82 58, 100 58 C122 58, 132
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12, 132 90 C132 108, 122 122, 100
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122 C82 122, 68 112, 68 98Z"
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```

**Engineers stay
building while
human making
becomes a relic of
the past...**

beginne

Here's what I built.

```
font-family="Inter, system-ui, sans-serif"><text x="24" y="116" font-size="10" letter-spacing="1.2" fill="#6f6a65">PITCH PROGRESS</text><text x="296" y="116" font-size="10" text-anchor="end" fill="#6f6a65" font-weight="700">0 / 11</text><rect x="24" y="122" width="272" height="3" rx="1.5" fill="#ede8e0"/></g><g text-anchor="middle"><g transform="translate(140, 168) scale(0.2)"><circle cx="100" cy="100" r="76" fill="none" stroke="#C8B6E2" stroke-width="9"/><line x1="24.06" y1="62" x2="175.94" y2="62" stroke="#F9A8D4" stroke-width="9" stroke-linecap="round"/><line x1="24" y1="100" x2="176" y2="100" stroke="#FDBA74" stroke-width="9" stroke-linecap="round"/><line x1="24.06" y1="138" x2="175.94" y2="138" stroke="#FDE68A" stroke-width="9" stroke-linecap="round"/><ellipse cx="100" cy="100" rx="52" ry="76" fill="none" stroke="#7BC47A" stroke-width="9"/><ellipse cx="100" cy="100" rx="26" ry="76" fill="none" stroke="#7DD3FC" stroke-width="9"/><line x1="100" y1="24" x2="100"
```

*Here's what I'd like to
build.*

```
x="112" y="0" width="38" height="22"
rx="11" fill="#ffdf7"
stroke="#ede8e0"/><text x="131"
y="14" text-anchor="middle"
fill="#2d2a26">Tea</text><rect
x="156" y="0" width="62" height="22"
rx="11" fill="#ffdf7"
stroke="#ede8e0"/><text x="187"
y="14" text-anchor="middle"
fill="#2d2a26">Ceramics</text><rect
x="224" y="0" width="48" height="22"
rx="11" fill="#ffdf7"
stroke="#ede8e0"/><text x="248"
y="14" text-anchor="middle"
fill="#2d2a26">Bread</text></g><g
transform="translate(20, 168)" font-
family="Fraunces, Georgia, serif"
fill="#2d2a26"><rect x="0" y="0"
width="130" height="106" rx="10"
fill="#7bc47a"/><text x="65" y="62"
text-anchor="middle" font-size="30"
fill="#ffdf7" font-
weight="700">.t</text><text x="0"
y="124" font-size="12" font-
weight="700">Tara H. · Herbal
teas</text><text x="0" y="139" font-
family="Inter, sans-serif" font-size="10"
fill="#2d5a3d" font-weight="600">$420
seeded · 12 backers</text><rect
```

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Traction

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● May 18, 2026

App launched, tinkr is live.

● June 1, 2026

185 paying users.

○ Dec 1, 2026

\$100K ARR · 185 paying engineers.

○ Mar 1, 2027

\$225K ARR · 417 paying engineers.

○ Jun 1, 2027

\$400K ARR · cash-flow positive (MRR

exceeds monthly burn).

○ Sept 1, 2027

\$575K ARR · 1,065 paying engineers ·

operating on revenue.

○ Dec 1, 2027

\$750K ARR · 1,400 paying engineers ·

Series A from a position of strength.

EMPIRICAL BASIS

10 users · 11 days · \$9.03 in model costs. 10% convert to the \$9/mo pre-seed tier inside week 1; 100% of those upgrade to the \$45/mo seed tier inside week 2. The 18-month ramp scales that funnel 1,400× and walks signup velocity from ~1/day today to ~45/day by month 18 — bounded by what founder-led GTM and the combined \$181K Y1+Y2H1 model-cost budget actually support.

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beginne

GTM Market

\$2.85 billion a

year

22% of LinkedIn's 120 million

paying subscribers × \$9 a month.

26 million tech, engineering, and design

professionals already paying for a professional tool.

tinker is the next one.

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Vision Market

\$71.3 billion a

year

22% of Instagram's 3 billion users

use it a month.

22% of LinkedIn members are in tech, engineering, or

design. Same ratio applied to Instagram.

beginne

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Ask

\$500,000

18 months runway.



beginner
\$305K

YEAR 1

■ \$175K founder salary

■ \$130K running costs

YEAR 1 FIRST 6 MONTHS

\$175K

■ \$95K founder salary (6% inflation)

■ \$80K running costs (lifetime curve adj.)

BEYOND

\$20K

■ \$20K maker discovery seed + cushion

Thank you

<svg	
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viewBox="0 0 180 180" fill="none"	
Every line item in the \$500,000 ask, fully itemized	
role="img" aria-label="beginner	
seed mark"><rect width="180"	\$175,000
Founder salary, year 1	
12 months. Base + benefits, all in	
height="180" rx="40"	
fill="#2d5a3d"/><path d="M68 38	\$130,000
Running costs, year 1	
Anthropic API for both paying users and the free-tier conversion funnel (~\$111K combined, the dominant line) + legal + accounting + banking + SF travel to build GTM motions (two one-week trips a year; extended stay only if accepted to an incubator) + Industrious office + Claude Code + Vercel + Neon + Styth + GitHub.	
L68 138" stroke="#f5f3ef" stroke-	
width="10.5" stroke-	
Founder salary, year 2 (first 6 months)	\$95,000
~6% inflation built into the year-2 rate. Keeps the founder in year through the first half of year 2 without re-raising.	
<path d="M68 82	
C68 68, 82 58, 100 58 C122 58, 132	beginne
Running costs, year 2 (first 6 months)	\$80,000
Anthropic API ~\$70K — lower than naive linear extrapolation because the Y cohort moves past their pitch-building phase (seed-tier users have static pages; free-tier users mostly churn or enter maintenance use). Other line items (office, legal, stack, hardware of SF travel) ~\$10K.	
72, 132 90 C132 108, 122 122, 100	
122 C82 122, 68 112, 68 98Z"	
stroke="#f5f3ef" stroke-	
Maker discovery seed + cushion	\$20,000
Everything left after the 18 months of runway costs. A small seed for maker channel research (one beginner maker in the first year) plus a cushion for the unexpected. The engineer-only part is a viable venture business on its own; entering the maker market in scale is an investor decision once engineer GTM is proven.	
width="10.5" fill="none" stroke-	
linejoin="round"/><path d="M68 56	
C66 44, 78 34, 92 38 C88 44, 74 50,	
Total ask	\$500,000
68 56Z" fill="#7bc47a"/><path	
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YEAR 1 RUNNING COSTS — ITEMIZED	
Anthropic API — paying funnel (Sonnet for pre-seed week; seed tier minimal ongoing)	\$30,000
Anthropic API — free tier funnel (Haiku, 25-session cap, prompt-cached; dominant Y1 cost)	\$81,000
Legal + accounting + banking	\$6,500
SF travel — two one-week GTM trips	\$5,000
Industrious office (\$332/mo × 12)	\$4,000
Claude Code Max (\$200/mo × 12)	\$2,500
Stack — Vercel + Neon + Styth + GitHub + domain	\$1,000
Year 1 running costs total	\$130,000